

Hail Damage in North Atlanta: What to Do First After a Storm

Quarter-size hail was confirmed in Dacula, 1-inch hail hit Duluth, and another storm swept through Acworth in the first week of July 2026 alone, according to a North Georgia roofing report published July 27, 2026 (Source: domroofing.com, July 2026). For homeowners along the I-85 and GA-400 corridors - Suwanee, Lawrenceville, Duluth, and Cumming among them - that frequency means a roof will eventually be tested by hail. The most common question afterward is whether to call the insurer first or schedule a professional roof inspection. The documentation you gather in the days after a confirmed hail event shapes your entire claim.

The short answer: After confirmed hail in your area, document the damage the same week and get a professional roof inspection before you call your insurer, because hail bruises fracture the shingle mat under the granules and are almost never visible from the ground. **Who this affects:** Metro Atlanta homeowners in Gwinnett, Forsyth, and Cobb County suburbs along the I-85 and GA-400 corridors, especially those with aging asphalt shingle roofs. **What to do:** Schedule a photo-documented roof inspection to confirm and record hail damage before filing your insurance claim. **Timeline:** Within the same week of a confirmed hail event in your area, and before your policy renewal.

Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors uses AI-powered drone inspections to capture the granule loss and mat bruising that a driveway-level look misses, then delivers a comprehensive photo-documented report you can hand directly to an adjuster.

Should I call my insurer or get a roof inspection first after hail?

Get a professional roof inspection first, then call your insurer with documentation in hand. Hail bruises fracture the shingle mat beneath the granules - you feel them by hand on the roof, but from the driveway the roof can look perfect, which is why a professional inspection is the right first step after any confirmed hail event (Source: domroofing.com, July 2026). In Metro Atlanta, where many homes carry 1990s-era three-tab or architectural shingles nearing the end of their lifespan, an inspection distinguishes storm damage from ordinary aging - a distinction adjusters scrutinize closely. Filing blind, without knowing whether real damage exists, risks a denied claim on your record. The practical takeaway: confirm damage with photo documentation before you open a claim, so your filing rests on evidence rather than a hunch.

What does an AI drone inspection find that a ground check misses?

An AI-powered drone inspection documents hail bruising, granule loss, and flashing failures that are invisible from the ground. Because hail damage almost never shows from the driveway, a photo-documented aerial report gives you objective evidence of impact points across every slope. For homeowners in Roswell, Alpharetta, and Johns Creek - where two-story homes and steep-pitch roofs make manual inspection slow and risky - drone imagery captures the full roof plane in a single pass. That matters when an adjuster questions whether marks are hail strikes or foot traffic. The takeaway: request an inspection that produces dated, geolocated photos of each damaged area, not a verbal summary.

How does the insurance claim process work for hail damage in Georgia?

Most Georgia policies give you roughly 12 months to file a hail claim, and from filing to a decision commonly takes two to six weeks depending on how backed up the carrier is after a storm (Source: domroofing.com, July 2026). Once a claim is approved, the roof itself is usually replaced in one to two days. For homeowners across Dunwoody, Sandy Springs, and Brookhaven, that timeline means a summer hail event can still be documented and filed well before winter. The most important step is documenting damage the same week and filing the claim yourself. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors provides insurance claims assistance, helping homeowners assemble the photo evidence and scope of work an adjuster needs to evaluate a claim.

What is the difference between RCV and ACV on my policy?

RCV means replacement cost value and ACV means actual cash value - the difference decides how much of your roof replacement the insurer actually pays. On an RCV policy, recoverable depreciation is released only against the actual completed work and final invoice; on an ACV policy the check is yours, but it rarely covers a full replacement in the first place (Source: domroofing.com, July 2026). Metro Atlanta homeowners in older Decatur and Tucker neighborhoods, where roofs may be a decade or more into their service life, often find their policies have quietly shifted toward ACV as roofs age. The takeaway: read whether your policy pays RCV or ACV before the next storm, because it determines your out-of-pocket cost on a claim.

How do aging shingles affect my hail claim in Gwinnett and Cobb County?

Aging shingles complicate hail claims because worn roofs blur the line between storm damage and ordinary wear - the exact distinction adjusters use to approve or deny. Many Gwinnett and Cobb County homes built in the 1990s suburban tract boom now carry shingles at or past their expected lifespan, and hail striking a brittle, granule-thin roof leaves marks an adjuster may attribute to age rather than impact. That is precisely why documented, dated inspection photos matter - they establish the condition and the specific impact points before a dispute begins. A roof already losing granules to age still deserves a professional evaluation after confirmed hail. The takeaway: if your roof is 15 or more years old and hail has been confirmed nearby, document its condition promptly so storm damage is recorded before deterioration muddies the claim.

Which Metro Atlanta areas face the most hail exposure?

The I-85 and GA-400 corridors carry heavy hail exposure, with confirmed events in Dacula, Duluth, and Acworth within a single early-July week (Source: domroofing.com, July 2026). Recent statewide forecasts have projected hail up to quarter size, frequent lightning, and wind gusts up to 60 mph across north and central Georgia, with Metro Atlanta in the path of the system (Source: google.com, July 2026).

In Suwanee and Lawrenceville, dense 1990s and early-2000s subdivisions mean thousands of roofs of the same era and material age together, so a single hailstorm can damage an entire neighborhood at once. Cumming and the wider Forsyth corridor along GA-400 see repeated storm tracks, and homeowners there often face multiple hail events across a roof's lifespan. In Marietta and Kennesaw, older ranch homes and 1980s frame construction carry roofs that have already

weathered years of Georgia sun before hail arrives. Woodstock and the Cherokee County edge, where newer suburban builds sit on higher terrain, catch wind-driven hail that strikes at an angle and damages both shingles and gutters. Across all of these areas, a roofing contractor serving the North Atlanta suburbs sees the same pattern: driveway-level roofs look intact while the shingle mat beneath tells a different story.

What should Metro Atlanta homeowners check before and after a storm?

Location	Housing type / era	Hail-related risk	Homeowner action
Suwanee / Lawrenceville	1990s-2000s tract subdivisions	Entire streets share the same aging shingle age	Schedule a neighborhood-wide inspection after confirmed hail
Cumming / Forsyth (GA-400)	Suburban builds on repeated storm tracks	Multiple hail events over a roof's lifespan	Document each event before filing to preserve claim history
Marietta / Kennesaw	1980s ranch and frame construction	Sun-aged shingles crack more easily under impact	Confirm damage vs. wear with dated inspection photos
Woodstock (Cherokee edge)	Newer builds on higher terrain	Wind-driven hail damages shingles and gutters	Inspect roof and seamless gutters together
Duluth / Norcross	Mixed 1990s stock along I-85	Frequent confirmed hail events	File within the ~12-month Georgia window with documentation

The takeaway: match your action to your roof's age and your area's storm history, and inspect the roof and gutters as one system.

What happens after a hail claim is approved for roof replacement?

After approval, the roof itself is usually replaced in one to two days, and on an RCV policy your recoverable depreciation releases against the final invoice for completed work. For Metro Atlanta homeowners, this is the point where contractor selection matters most, because a full roof replacement is only as durable as its installation and the warranty behind it. As a GAF Master Elite certified contractor - a designation held by only a small fraction of U.S. roofers - Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors carries factory-backed manufacturer warranties that standard installs cannot provide, and holds CertainTeed Select ShingleMaster credentials as well. For homeowners weighing out-of-pocket costs such as deductibles, Wells Fargo financing options can spread the expense of a new roof installation. The takeaway: choose a licensed and insured roofing contractor whose certification unlocks stronger manufacturer warranties before you schedule the work.

FAQ

Should I get a roof inspection before I call my insurance company after hail?

Yes - get a professional roof inspection before you call your insurer so your claim rests on documented evidence. Hail bruises fracture the shingle mat under the granules and are almost never visible from the ground, so a driveway look can miss real damage entirely. A photo-documented report confirms whether genuine hail damage exists before you open a claim. Filing without that evidence risks a denial on your record. Confirm the damage first, then file with documentation in hand.

How long do I have to file a hail damage claim in Georgia?

Most Georgia policies give you roughly 12 months to file a hail damage claim after the event. That window means a summer hail event in Gwinnett or Forsyth County can still be documented and filed well into the following season. Even so, documenting damage the same week keeps your evidence fresh and dated. The claim decision itself commonly takes two to six weeks depending on carrier backlog after a storm. Don't wait until the deadline nears - file with complete documentation as soon as damage is confirmed.

Will my insurance pay for a full roof replacement after hail?

Whether insurance covers a full roof replacement depends on whether your policy pays RCV or ACV. On an RCV policy, the insurer releases recoverable depreciation against the completed work, so a full replacement can be covered once the job is done and invoiced. On an ACV policy, the check is yours up front but rarely covers a full replacement. Metro Atlanta homeowners with older roofs sometimes find their coverage has shifted toward ACV as the roof ages. Read your policy's valuation terms before the next storm to know your likely out-of-pocket cost.

Why does hail damage not show up from the ground on my roof?

Hail damage rarely shows from the ground because the impact fractures the shingle mat beneath the granules rather than leaving an obvious surface hole. You can feel these bruises by hand on the roof, but from the driveway the roof can look perfect. This is exactly why a professional inspection - ideally with drone imagery - is the right first step after any confirmed hail event in your

area. An aerial photo-documented report captures each impact point across every slope. Never assume your roof is fine just because it looks undamaged from below.

How much of my roof claim do I owe if I have an ACV policy in Cobb County?

On an ACV policy, you typically owe the gap between the depreciated payout and the full replacement cost, which is often substantial for a Cobb County homeowner. Actual cash value pays the roof's depreciated worth, and that check rarely covers a complete replacement - especially for the aging 1990s shingles common in Marietta and Kennesaw subdivisions. The older the roof, the larger that gap tends to be. Reviewing whether your policy is ACV or RCV before hail strikes helps you plan for the cost. Financing options can also help bridge the difference on a new roof installation.

Does a hail claim raise my chances of denial if my roof is old?

An older roof can raise the risk of a hail claim being questioned, because adjusters must separate storm damage from ordinary age-related wear. Aging shingles that are already losing granules blur that line, and marks may be attributed to age rather than impact. Dated, geolocated inspection photos taken promptly after a confirmed hail event establish the condition and the specific impact points before any dispute. For homes 15 years or older in areas like Decatur or Tucker, this documentation is especially valuable. Record your roof's condition quickly so storm damage is preserved as evidence.

What should I do if hail was confirmed near my Suwanee home but I see no damage?

Schedule a professional roof inspection anyway, because confirmed hail near your Suwanee home can cause mat damage you cannot see from the ground. The dense 1990s and 2000s subdivisions along the I-85 corridor mean many neighboring roofs share the same age and material, so a single storm often damages an entire street. An inspection with a photo-documented report tells you definitively whether impacts exist. If damage is found, you have evidence ready for a claim within Georgia's filing window. Waiting until leaks appear can push you past that window and complicate coverage.

How quickly can my roof be replaced after a hail claim is approved?

After a hail claim is approved, the roof itself is usually replaced in one to two days. The longer part of the process is the claim decision, which commonly runs two to six weeks depending on how backed up your carrier is after a storm. For Metro Atlanta homeowners along GA-400 in Cumming or Alpharetta, that means most of the timeline is administrative rather than construction. Choosing a certified contractor keeps the installation fast and backed by strong manufacturer warranties. Have your documentation and contractor lined up so work can begin as soon as approval comes through.

Contact Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors for a free inspection.

Written by Jonathan Gil, Licensed Roofing Contractor, Metro Atlanta. Peachtree Roofing & Exteriors serves homeowners across Metro Atlanta.